was not arranged by their parents. Sadhana worked closely with Amte in all his endeavours, beginning with their first attempt at creating an equitable community, Shram Ashram, soon after their wedding.

In 1985, an ailing seventy-two-year-old Amte launched a bicycle rally from Kanyakumari to Kashmir, called the ‘Bharat Jodo Yatra’. It was meant to encourage people to reject communal violence and promote national unity.



On the side of the dispossessed

In the 1970s, Amte founded the Lok Biradari Prakalp, an organization aimed at bringing healthcare and basic education to the Madia-Gond tribal community. Located in Gadchiroli district, Maharashtra, the Madia-Gonds lived in poverty and suffered from a variety of common illnesses caused by poor nutrition. Amte, along with his son and daughter-in-law, set up various institutions, including a hospital and a facility to teach the community agricultural techniques and basic reading, writing and arithmetic skills. Amte was also involved in protests against large hydroelectric projects (including those planned in the Narmada Valley) that would destroy forests and dispossess thousands of people of their land and homes. For his work through the years, which inspired many around the world, he received